Colour for your website and business

Yes – but it depends where and why you use it.

On a customer red works mainly as a **colour of attention**, **energy**, **action** and **urgency**. It can say “Look here”, “this is important”, “now is the time to act”. That is why it is used well in advertising, on **buttons**, for **special offers**, **discounts** and **striking offers**.

By itself, though, it **does not attract money or customers** like a magnet. It can help **catch** attention and **highlight** an offer, but what still decides is mainly **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Red can say, for example

“Notice me.” “Something is happening here.” “This is important.” “Take action.”

- **Attention and urgency.** It is seen before other colours. It suits places where something should happen right now.
- **Energy and appetite.** It awakens appetite, movement and the wish to try something.
- **Courage and boldness.** A brand that wants to be seen and is not afraid to show it.
- **Passion and warmth.** In rich and brick shades it feels human and warm.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also feel different. A bright red is **more active** and **louder**, wine red feels **deeper** and **more elegant**, brick warmer and more human, coral friendlier.

Simple tips

Use it as an accent

A button, a price, a heading or one striking element is often enough.

Do not put it everywhere

When everything is red, nothing is important any more.

Shade by brand

Bright red for action, wine for elegance, brick for warmth, coral for friendliness.

Test it on the real website

Not just as a colour swatch. What looks good on its own can feel completely different on a page.

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Professions where it is a Yes

Gastronomy, street food and bakeries

Red highlights taste, pace and appetite well. Try it on packaging, a sign or one striking element. For a quiet café where guests want to sit for a while, I would choose brick or wine rather than a glaring red.

Sport, dance and events

Red can invite people to movement, a meeting and a quick decision. Give it a clear task on the poster. One date, one “sign up” button or one title. If you highlight everything, the organiser will be loud even on paper.

Fashion, creative projects and a personal brand

For a woman who wants to be seen, red may feel natural. Choose the shade according to the nature of the work. Wine feels elegant, coral friendly, brick warm. Let the work itself stand out, not just the colour.

Discounts, offers and calls to action

Red has proved itself on buttons, prices and time-limited offers, because it says “now”. But it works only when there is room left around it. A red page with no rest is more likely to tire the customer.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Wellness, therapy and meditation.** You are selling calm, quiet and safety. A rich red can go against the intended impression. A subtle detail or a muted shade may work better.
- **Sensitive counselling, grief and crisis help.** A woman often arrives tired or vulnerable. An urgent colour can feel like pressure.
- **Finance and law with an emphasis on discretion.** Quiet elegance and trust are carried better in calm tones. Red can stay in a small accent.
- **A place where red already means prohibition or warning.** More red decoration can visually drown an important signal.

Give important information clearly legible dark text.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer, and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the red?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that red means energy and passion.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know red from shops, adverts and the street. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Coca-Cola (drinks)**
  Red, white lettering and a logotype you recognise even without reading it. The colour says: energy, taste, joy. It is often said that Coca-Cola invented the red Santa Claus. That is not true; he had a red coat before its adverts. Those from the 1930s, however, helped popularise him and tied red to Christmas as well.

- **Ferrari (cars)**
  “Rosso corsa”, racing red, was originally the colour of Italian racing cars. Today we associate it with speed, passion and prestige, and most Ferraris sold are in fact red.

- **Netflix and YouTube (video streaming)**
  The red logo and the play button say: press it, watch it, something interesting is going on. Here red works as an action button.

- **Christian Louboutin (footwear)**
  He first used the red sole around 1992 or 1993, when he borrowed red nail polish from an assistant. The colour of the sole is Pantone 18-1663 TPX. In 2012 a US court confirmed the brand's exclusive right to the red sole on shoes with an otherwise differently coloured upper.

What they have in common is that red carries a simple message. **Attention, taste, now**. And it is mostly not everywhere, only where it is meant to stand out.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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